

PROGRESSION · TIMELINE · STRUCTURE

# authority-chain

Provenance chain — statute to regulation to guidance to case, walked in order.

# COPPA — the chain, tier by tier.

## STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

## REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

## GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

## CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalised "actual knowledge" standard.

# COPPA — one statute, many branches.

## STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501 COPPA, 1998

16 C.F.R. Part 312 FTC implementing rule

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan staff guidance

In re Epic Games · 2022 \$245M consent order

In re YouTube/Google · 2019 \$170M consent order

# COPPA — statute through case, left to right.

|                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                      |                                                                                             |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <div>01</div> <div>STATUTE</div> <div>15 U.S.C. §6501</div> <div>→</div> <div>Verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.</div> | <div>02</div> <div>REGULATION</div> <div>16 C.F.R. Part 312</div> <div>→</div> <div>FTC implementing rule.</div> | <div>03</div> <div>GUIDANCE</div> <div>FTC Six-Step Plan</div> <div>→</div> <div>Cited in every consent order.</div> | <div>04</div> <div>CASE</div> <div>Epic Games · 2022</div> <div>\$245M consent order.</div> |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

# COPPA — the authority pyramid.

## STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — consent for under-13 data.

## REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule.

## GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Plan

Staff guidance, non-binding.

## CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order.

# How the GDPR fine traces back to the treaty.

|            |                                                                                                                          |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TREATY     | <p>Charter of Fundamental Rights, Art. 8</p> <p>EU primary law — protection of personal data is a fundamental right.</p> |
| REGULATION | <p>GDPR (EU) 2016/679</p> <p>Directly applicable across all member states; sets the Art. 83 fine tiers.</p>              |
| GUIDANCE   | <p>EDPB Guidelines 04/2022</p> <p>Harmonised methodology for calculating administrative fines.</p>                       |
| DECISION   | <p>DPC v. Meta · 2023</p> <p>€1.2B fine — the largest GDPR penalty to date.</p>                                          |

# COPPA — the chain, tier by tier.

## STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

## REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

## GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

## CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalised "actual knowledge" standard.

# COPPA — the chain, tier by tier.

## STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

## REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

## GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

## CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalised "actual knowledge" standard.



## COPPA — the chain, tier by tier.

### STATUTE

15 U.S.C. §6501

Congress, 1998 — verifiable parental consent for under-13 data.

### REGULATION

16 C.F.R. Part 312

FTC implementing rule; 2013 rewrite expanded covered identifiers.

### GUIDANCE

FTC Six-Step Compliance Plan

Staff guidance — non-binding, but cited in every consent order.

### CASE

In re Epic Games · 2022

\$245M consent order — operationalised "actual knowledge" standard.

## When NOT to reach for authority-chain.

**Flat list of citations.** If the rows have no tier hierarchy, use `list-criteria` or `regulatory-update`. `authority-chain` earns its chrome only when the descent from statute to case is the point.

**Missing citation chip.** The inline-code citation is the row's anchor; without it the gloss reads as opinion. Always cite, even for guidance and case rows.

**Out-of-order tiers.** The chain reads as a descent: statute first, case last. Reversing it or skipping a tier breaks the metaphor the audience is using to follow you.

# See also.

## *RELATED COMPONENTS*

`regulatory-update` — period-bounded changelog rather than a single rule's lineage

`list-criteria` — flat enumeration of requirements without tier hierarchy

`timeline` — the sequence is chronological events, not legal tiers

`list-steps` — the rows are procedural steps rather than authority tiers